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«Trump's tariffs didn't work last time – and wouldn't likely now»

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OPINION

Trump's tariffs didn't work last time – and wouldn't likely now

Trump's previous trade war tariffs made US even more reliant on foreign suppliers, raised consumer prices and invited retaliation

By MARK JOHNSON And MEHMET CHAKKOL
OCTOBER 25, 2024



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Tariffs were then imposed on a wide range of goods, from imported steel and aluminum to solar panels and washing machines.

But did they work? Our research suggests not.

In fact, we found that imposing tariffs actually made the US even more reliant on foreign suppliers – and failed to stimulate the domestic job market. They also raised costs for US consumers and provoked retaliatory tariffs from trading partners including China, the EU, Canada, Mexico, India and Turkey.

China for example, responded by trebling tariffs on American cars. The EU filed a dispute with the World Trade Organization and substantially raised tariffs on US exports including Harley Davidson motorcycles, jeans and bourbon whiskey.


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